

THE NEW-AGE BANK

Bank of India's strategic push into artificial intelligence as part of its broader transformation is beginning to pay off

BY KRISHNA GOPALAN



Rajneesh Karnatak, MD & CEO, Bank of India

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I **T IS NEVER** too late to make a change in any organisation, even if it has been around for over a century. Take Bank of India. The bank was founded in 1906 and remained private till 1969 when it was nationalised along with 13 others.

However, in the last few years, Bank of India has taken two big initiatives, Project Star NextTech (focus on enterprise technology and digital trans-

formation) and Project Star Light (thrust on innovation and growth in human talent), with a clear objective of ushering in a transformation that will lead to improved operating efficiency, faster turnarounds and risk analytics plus scalable growth. The aim is to make the bank strong for a future that presents challenges and opportunities in equal measure.

Not surprisingly, Rajneesh Karnatak, MD & CEO, Bank of India, has been recognised as the

business transformation leader of the year (PSB) in the *BT-KPMG* Survey of India's Best Banks and NBFCs for efforts to strengthen business efficiency in Bank of India.

TAKING THE BIG STEPS

Karnatak's initiatives on the digital side are not restricted to IT but also cover cybersecurity. At the earnings call for the third quarter of FY26, he outlined how automation is being used in many of the